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VENTURE CAPITAL

Adverb Ventures raising \$125 million for its second fund for early-stage startups

By [Kia Kokalitcheva](#)

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[Adverb Ventures](#), founded and led by prominent former Silicon Valley execs April Underwood and Jessica Verrilli, is seeking \$125 million for its second fund, according to an SEC filing.

This is not only a significant bump from the firm’s first fund, which closed \$75 million in commitments in 2023, but is also an ambitious undertaking in a market that’s been [quite challenging for emerging fund managers](#).

Adverb invests in early-stage startups, from pre-seed rounds to Series A, writing checks from \$500,000 to \$5 million.

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Underwood and Verrilli have both held leadership roles at top tech companies. Both worked at Twitter (now [X](#)) in the 2010s, rising to jobs including director of product and vice president of corporate development, respectively. Underwood became [Slack](#)’s chief product officer and later a startup founder, while Verrilli was general partner at Alphabet’s venture arm, [GV](#), according to LinkedIn.

The pair also established #Angels in 2015 alongside other fellow female execs and Twitter alumni as an angel investor group aiming to get more women into startups. The 2018 study, in partnership with cap table management company [Carta](#), put the spotlight on the dizzying gender gap in startup equity ownership. At the time, it found that while women comprised about 33% of startup employees and founders, they only owned 9% of startup equity value.

As of 2024, women made up only 17.3% of decision makers at US venture firms with at least \$50 million in AUM, and only 10.3% of firms had women as at least 50% of decision makers, according to [PitchBook’s latest report on the subject](#).

Neither founder of Adverb returned a request for comment.

Featured image by Jenna O'Malley/PitchBook News

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About [Kia Kokalitcheva](#)

Kia Kokalitcheva leads PitchBook's US venture capital news team and is based in San Francisco. With over a decade of experience covering Silicon Valley, startups, VCs, and the broader dealmaking world, she brings deep expertise and curiosity to the newsroom. Kia previously worked at Axios, Fortune, and VentureBeat. She holds a bachelor's degree in Political Economy from UC Berkeley, where she was a columnist for its award-winning student newspaper, The Daily Californian.

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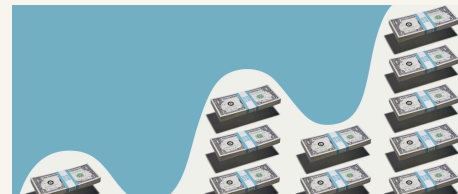


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